[Metric]
A-A-3076
December 8, 1997

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
FILE FOLDERS, SHELF
(VARIOUS CUTS)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all Federal Agencies which replaces Federal Specification UU-F-1206 which has been canceled.

1. **Scope:** This Commercial Item Description covers 2 types, 3 grades, 2 styles, and 3 sizes of shelf, file folders (with or without fasteners), which have an expansion of 9.53 mm to 25.4 mm (3/8 to 1 inch) and are used for document filing.

2. **Classification:**

Type:	I. - General Purpose	
	II. - Special Purpose	
Grade:	A. - Extra-Heavy Duty	{25 Point}
	B. - Heavy Duty	{17 Point}
	C. - Standard Duty	{11 Point}
Style:	1. - With Fasteners	
	2. - Without Fasteners	
Size:	A. - Letter	{298.5 x 241.3 mm [11.750 x 9.5 inches]}
	B. - Legal	{374.7 x 241.3 mm [14.750 x 9.5 inches]}
	C. - Custom	As Specified

3. **Salient Characteristics:**

3.1 **Material.** The files folders as cited in this commercial item description shall be comprised from fibrous, cellulose materials and conform to the physical properties as specified Table I.

3.1.1 **Paperboard.** The paperboard used for each grade shall be as follows: Grade A - Extra Heavy Duty (Pressboard); Grade B - Heavy Duty (Kraft or Manila); and Grade C - Standard Duty (Kraft or Manila) as specified in Table I.

3.1.2 **Grain.** The grain of the paperboard shall be parallel to the short side of the folder when held in its closed position, when tested as specified in accordance with Table II.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7530

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Table I.
Physical Properties

Characteristics	Grade A Extra-Heavy Duty	Grade B Heavy Duty	Grade C Standard Duty
Basis Weight (24 x 36 x 500)	602.16 g/m2 (370 pounds)	353.16 g/m2 (217 pounds)	239.24 g/m2 (147 pounds)
Tolerance	-5% + 8%	-5% + 8%	-5% + 8%
Thickness	.025	.017	.011
Tolerance	± .00381 mm (± .0015 inch)	± .00381 mm (± .0015 inch)	- .00254 mm ± .00127 mm (- .001" + .0005 inch)
Stiffness (gurley / minimum)			
MD, gm	36,000	11,200	3,300
CD, gm	11,700	4,400	1,200
Smoothness (max.) Sheffield Felt / Wire	200	220	200
Bursting Strength, min. avg., lb./Sq. in.	180		
Tear, total of both directions		800	475

Table II.
Testing of Components

Paperboard Characteristic	Specification Referenced
Sampling	Par. 5.1.1 - TAPPI T 400
Grain	Par. 3.1.2 - TAPPI T 409
Basis Weight	Table I - TAPPI T 410
Thickness	Table I - TAPPI T 411
Tearing Resistance, Total - Both Directions	Table I - TAPPI T 414
Stiffness	Table I - TAPPI T 543
Smoothness	Table I - TAPPI T 538
Bursting Strength	Table I - TAPPI T 807
Cloth Gusset	ASTM - D - 1424
Spunbonded Polyolefin	ASTM - D - 1922
Laminated Sheeting Gusset	ASTM - D - 1004

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3.1.3 Gusset Material. Folders fabricated from grade A paperboard shall have the front and back leaves joined by a gusset material listed below at the option of the manufacturer. The color of the gusset shall be complimentary to the paperboard color, and shall compare favorably in color, hue, and intensity to gusset material used in the commercial production of similar file folders. The gusset shall be two-ply with the end (on the width) joined on the inside so that there is at least a 6.350 mm (1/4 inch) overlap. The gusset shall provide for an expansion of 25.5 mm ± 3.175 mm (1 inch ± 1/8 inch), with one fold inward and parallel to the leaves. The gusset material shall be glued on each side of the leaves over a width not less than 12.70 mm (1/2 inch) and not more than 25.4 mm (1 inch). The gusset shall be firmly glued to the folder so that its removal results in paperboard failure and not the adhesive bond failure.

3.1.3.1 Cloth Gusset. If used, the cloth gusset shall be well sized and filled so that the fold does not lose shape or flatten out when the folder is used. The cloth shall have a thread count of not less than 60 threads in the warp and not less than 50 threads in the filling when tested in accordance with ASTM D 1424. The cloth gusset (two plies of cloth) shall have an Elmendorf Tearing Strength of not less than 900 grams in the long direction (when folder is held in the closed position).

3.1.3.2 Spunbonded Polyolefin Gusset. If used, the file folder gusset shall be made from two plies of Spunbonded Polyolefin material which shall not lose its shape or flatten out in use. The Spunbonded Polyolefin gusset shall have an Elmendorf Tearing Strength of not less than 400 grams in the long direction (when the folder is held in the closed position) when tested in accordance with ASTM D 1922.

3.1.3.3 Laminated Sheeting Gusset Material. If used, the file folder with laminated gusset sheeting shall have a minimum thickness of 1.0 mil or as specified in the contract or ordering document. The material shall not lose its shape or flatten out in use. The laminated sheeting material shall be tested in accordance with ASTM 1004 and yield a force no less than 500 grams-force.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Type I & II File Folders. Type I & II drawer, file folders shall be fabricated from the grade board specified in paragraph 3.1.1. The folders shall be formed by folding the board to form a front and back leaf. The dimensions on the front and back leaf shall be as specified for the applicable size in the contract or ordering document. When specified the front leaf shall be scored 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) expansion at 9.53 mm (3/8) or 6.35 mm (1/4 inch) intervals across the bottom width of the folder. When specified, type I folders with straight-cut tabs shall be scored on the tab using two single lines to show the position of 1/3 cut tabs. All top corners of the folders shall be rounded (Rounded corners may include "S" Curves).

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3.2.2 Grade A Folders. Grade A folders shall be constructed of two leaves of grade A board joined by one piece of gusset material in accordance with paragraphs 3.1.3. The gusset material shall provide for an expansion of one or two inches between the leaves as specified in the item description. The front leaf shall be scored for 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) expansions, at 9.53 mm (3/8 inch) interval, across the bottom width of the folder. The tab portion (top) of the back leaf, for all size folders shall be scored for 1/3 cut positions. The edges of the front leaves shall be paralleled to the corresponding edges of the back leaves.

3.2.3 Grade B Folders. Grade B folders shall be fabricated from grade B paperboard in accordance with paragraph 3.1.1 and table I of this commercial item description. The folders shall be formed by folding the board to form a front and back leaf. The dimensions on the front and back leaf shall be as specified for the applicable size. When specified the front leaf shall be scored 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) expansion at 9.53mm (3/8 inch) or 6.35 mm (1/4 inch) interval across the bottom width of the folder. The tab portion (top) of the back leaf, for all size folders shall be scored for 1/3 cut positions.

3.2.4 Grade C Folders. Grade C folders shall be fabricated from grade C paperboard in accordance paragraph 3.1.1 and table I of this commercial item description. When specified, the folder shall be provided with fasteners and shall be in accordance with paragraph 3.6.

3.3 Dimensions.

3.3.1 Size A, B & C. The width of both the front and back leaves shall be as specified in the contract or ordering document.

3.4 Tabs.

3.4.1 Double Top Tab (if required). The back leaf of the folder shall be reinforced along the top or side tab edge, as applicable, for the specified drawer file folder. The reinforcing material shall be the same stock as the folder and shall be 28.58 mm (1 1/8 inches), 1.59 mm ± (1/16 inch) in total width, including the tab and measured from the edge of the tab; extending the full length of the folder edge. The reinforcement shall be securely glued to the inner portion of the folder back leaf.

3.4.2 Straight Plastic Tabs. When the tab is viewed from the side, the front portion of the plastic tab shall form an angle of 12° ± 5° with the self tab. The point where the front of the plastic tab extends furthest from the surface of the self tab shall not be less than 2.38 mm (3/32 inch) minimum face height.

3.4.3 Self Tabs. Self tabs shall be a horizontal extension of the back leaf.. The tab corners shall be rounded which may include S curves.

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3.4.4 Plastic Tabs. Plastic tabs shall be fabricated from cellulose acetate, polyvinyl chloride, or other suitable plastic, having a film thickness not less than .254 mm (0.01 inch). The plastic tab shall cover the self tab to within 1.59 mm (1/16 inch) of the curve side of the self tab. The plastic tab shall accommodate paper inserts which are in accordance with the requirements of paragraph 3.5 and hold the insert supplied with the folders. The plastic tab shall be attached firmly to the folder by solvent or heat sealing, so that its removal results from paperboard failure and not from sealing failure.

3.5 Inserts. A sufficient number (equal to folders in box, or up to 33 % overage) of blank white paper inserts, for metal or plastic tabs, shall be furnished in perforated strips, so they can be inserted through a typewriter and then readily detached from the strip. These inserts shall be the width of the tab for which they were designed, + 1.59 mm (1/16) or - 3.17 mm (1/8 inch). If preprinted paper inserts are specified, they shall be banded and attached with the blank white inserts to the top folder of each box. Inserts shall fit in the tabs that they are designed for, without use of tape or excessive bowing. Excessive bowing is defined as that which makes legibility difficult.

3.6 Fasteners. The fastener shall be fabricated from steel, finished with a commercially acceptable corrosion resistant material. Fasteners (when specified) shall be located on the back and front leaves in the number one and or three positions, respectively. The fasteners shall be located 14.29 mm (9/16 inch) from the left side of the folder (left side as the folder is in its closed, file position) to the vertical centerline of the fastener prongs. For type I folders, the tip of the right prong of the number three fastener shall be two inches from the fold; the tip of the prong of the number one fastener shall be one inch from the fold. For type II folders, the tip of each fastener prong closest to the fold shall be 39.69 mm (1 9/16 inches) from the fold. Fasteners must be able to bend to accommodate two - hole punched paper with 69.85 mm ± 0.79 mm (2 3/4 ± 1/32 inch) between the centers of the holes.

3.6.1 Clinch Type Fasteners. A two-prong fastener, ribbed lengthwise for rigidity, with tapered or rounded ends, made of baked enamel finish steel, with a thickness of 0.356 mm ± 0.005 mm (0.014 ± 0.002 inch). The fastener shall be set in indentation on the outside of the back and front leaves and be flush with the surface of the folder; fasteners shall be closely secured by no less than eight clinching ears or tabs.

3.6.2 Bonded Type Fasteners. A two-prong fastener with tapered or rounded ends, made of baked enamel finish steel, with a thickness of 0.356 mm ± 0.005 mm (0.014 ± 0.002 inch). The fastener shall be centered on and bonded to a non-woven fabric, which shall have a thickness of 0.305 mm to 0.382 mm (0.012 to 0.015 inch), and have an Elmendorf tear resistance of 550 grams minimum in each direction, and shall be 0.305 mm to 0.382 mm (0.012 to 0.015 inch) in thickness. The non-woven fabric with steel fastener shall be bonded to the inner side of the folder board, so that removal of the fastener results in paperboard failure or tearing of the bonding non-woven fabric overlay.

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3.6.3 Fastener Positions: The fastener positions shall be identified as follows: A - Not Applicable; B - Position 1 Top Right Leaf; C - Position 2 Bottom Right Leaf; D - Position 3 Top Left Leaf; E - Position 4 Bottom Left Leaf; F - Position 5 At Fold Right Leaf; G - Position 6 At Fold Left Leaf; H - Position 7 Left Edge Left Leaf; I - Position 8 Right Edge Right Leaf; J - As Specified.

3..6.3.1 Right Panel, One Inch Capacity. Unless otherwise specified, fasteners shall be positioned 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) from at the top folder edge to the center line of the fastener base. The left prong shall be positioned 34.93 mm (1 3/8 inch) from the folded edge. A tolerance of ± 1.59 mm (1/16 inch) shall be allowed, for all positions.

3.6..3.2 Left Panel, One Inch Capacity. Unless otherwise specified, fasteners shall be positioned 19.05 mm (3/4 inch) from at the top folder edge to the center line of the fastener base. The right prong shall be positioned 34.93 mm (1 3/8 inch) from the folded edge. A tolerance of ± 1.59 mm (1/16 inch) shall be allowed, for all positions.

Note: For legal size folders add 38.1 mm (1 1/2 inch) to the distance from the prong edge. For 50.8 mm (2 inch) capacity fasteners subtract 25.4 mm (1 inch) from the prong to the edge, for all positions.

3.7 Corrosion Resistance. All metal parts (fasteners) shall be corrosion resistant in accordance with normal commercial practices. The contractor shall provide a manufacturer's chemical certification of corrosion resistance upon request by the Government.

3.8 Punching. When punching is required, file folders shall be furnished with punched holes. The contract or purchase order shall specify location and dimensions of punched holes.

3.9 Workmanship. Folders shall be clean and free from hard shives, dirt spots, holes, blisters, tears, or wrinkles and shall have a smooth uniform finish. Edges shall be cleanly cut, without nicks or ragged edges. Die cuts to make the rounded corners may remain as long as they can be easily removed with little or no effort. Folders shall be free from any other defects which may affect their serviceability or appearance.

4. Regulatory Requirements: The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 20% Postconsumer fiber as defined by the Paper Products Recovered Materials Advisory Notice (Paper RMAN) and the Executive Order 12995 dated March 25, 1996. The Paper RMAN is found in the Federal Register, Vol. 61, Part IV dated May 29, 1996.

4.1 Labeling of Recycled Content. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

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4.2 Bleaching: To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this commercial item description, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5. Quality Assurance Provisions:

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.1.1 Testing. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the referenced tests in this Commercial Item Description. (Note: See TAPPI T 400 for specific sampling instructions and acceptance criteria).

6. Packaging:

6.1 Packaging, packing, marking, and palletization shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Part Identification Number (PIN). The following part identification numbering procedure is for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

This example describes a part numbering system for CID **A-A-3076**

A-A- 2 A 2 C — Example of reference part number for an file folder, drawer

Size:	A. Letter B. Legal C. Custom
Style:	1. - With Fasteners 2. - Without Fasteners
Grade:	A. Heavy Duty B. Standard Duty C. Light Duty
Type:	1 - Type I - General Purpose 2 - Type II - Special Purpose

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7.2 **Source of Documents.** The following documents form a part of the Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

7.2.1 Copies of Executive Order 12995 may be obtained from: The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building, White House, Att: Publications, Washington, DC. 20500 (202) 395-7332.

7.2.2 The Final (Paper RMAN) is available from the Environmental Protection Agency's public access server on the Internet or from the RCRA Hotline. The Hotline can be reached toll-free at (800) 424-9346.

7.2.3 Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) test methods cited in this CID may be obtained from TAPPI, Technology Park, PO Box 105113, Atlanta, Georgia, 30348-5113.

7.2.4 Copies of the appropriate ASTM's may be obtained from the American Standards for Testing Materials at 100 Barr Harbor Dr., West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

7.3 **Ordering Data:** Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A - Title, number and date of this specification.
B - Type, Class, Style and Grade required.
C - Width of leaves required.
D - Whether bleaching without use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or chlorine compound is required.

7.4 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN's).** The following is a list of nsn's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the CID.

7530-00-739-7723	7530-00-926-8975	7530-00-926-8983
7530-00-881-2957	7530-00-926-8977	7530-00-926-8984
7530-00-926-8974	7530-00-926-8979	

Military Interests:

Military Custodians.
Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review Activities.
Air Force - 84

User Activity.
Army - AV

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA - FSS
NASA - JFK

Preparing Activity:
GSA - FSS (2FYEE)

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8. **Figure:**

STANDARD FASTENER POSITIONS

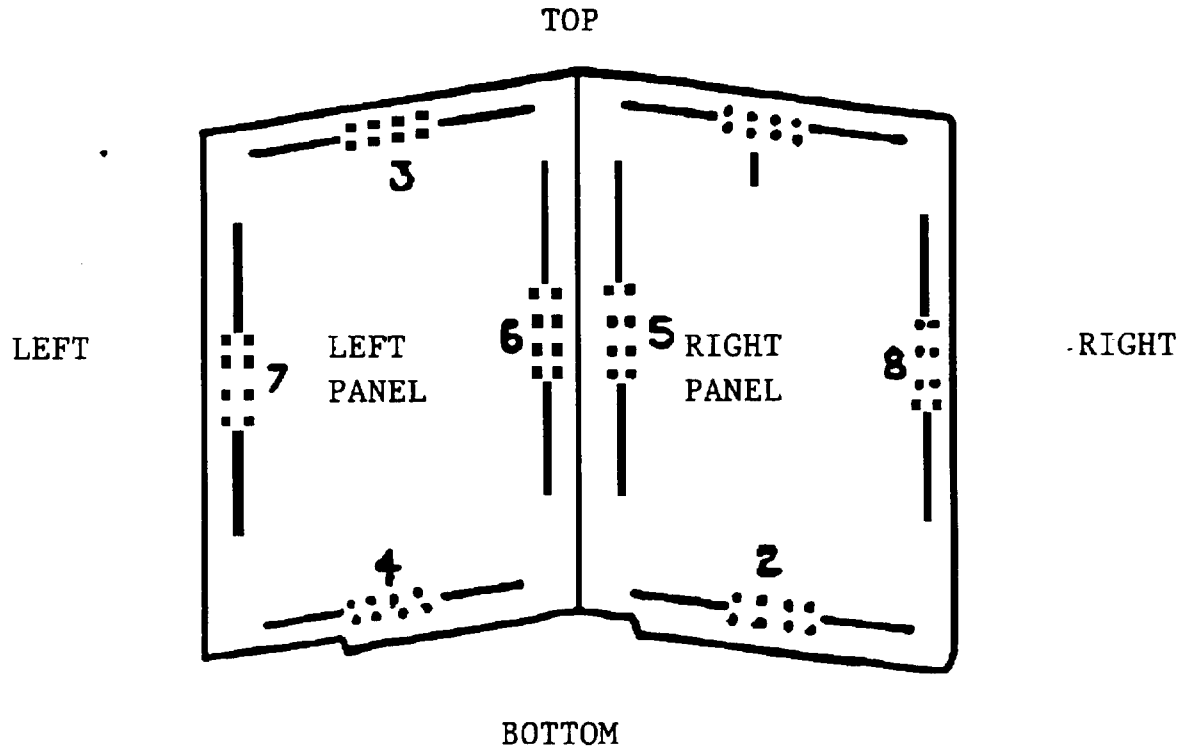


Figure 1

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